

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp. (OCBC.SI)

4Q25 Earnings Review: Wealth & ASEAN focus a positive, but clearer financial accountability needed; Buy

OCBC.SI

12m Price Target: **S\$23.50**Price: **S\$21.40**Upside: **9.8%**
 **BUY**
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OCBC posted 4Q25 net profit of S\$1,745mn, 3% yoy/-12% qoq, above GSe (+3%). PBT was S\$2,113, above GSe (+8%) - see [First Take: Beat on lower credit cost offsetting lower PPOP on weaker non-NII](#). The new corporate strategy and its associated measurable targets were a key focus of the analyst briefing. We see the increased emphasis on wealth-led expansion coming at an appropriate point in the growth cycle, consistent with our [thesis](#) that we are entering a new profitability cycle driven by structural liquidity and sustained wealth inflows underpinned by Asia's rising affluence and cross-border capital mobility, particularly from Mainland China. Given OCBC's focus on further strengthening their wealth franchise and the strong momentum in 2H25, we forecast the contribution from wealth fees to increase to 63%/65%/67% in FY26E/FY27E/FY28E, respectively from 60% in 2025. ASEAN as well will be a focus for management given the relatively higher macro growth especially in Malaysia and Indonesia. Meanwhile, management noted to stable to improving ROEs with no further explicit financial targets and time bound milestones to substantiate delivery with its new focus. That said, management acknowledged that given execution remains at an early stage, targets will be communicated more progressively as implementation advances. We therefore await clearer guidance and targets to better assess medium-term returns. Also, worth noting is that its subsidiary, Great Eastern Holdings (GEH) is expected to provide an update on its approach to the HNW segment next week, an area where it has historically been underweight.

Another focus point was on capital returns, given its still robust CET1 of 15.1% and its target of CET1 of 14% while remaining capital generative. Management made no commitment to further return capital other than its commitment to a dividend payout at 50% and noted that it will focus on growth. We look for further discussions on capital optimisation towards its target range on completion of the remaining S\$780mn from the S\$2.5bn capital return programme

Key Data

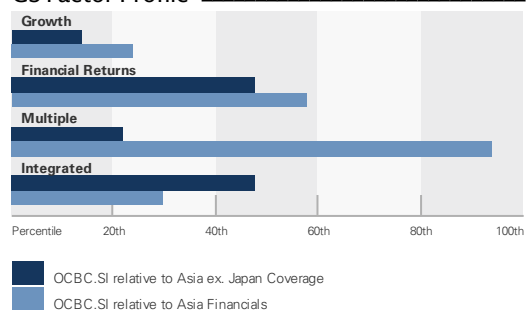
Market cap: S\$96.4bn / \$76.1bn
3m ADTV: S\$94.0mn / \$73.4mn
Singapore
Asia Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	7,587.0	7,422.0	7,486.9	7,843.7
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	7,587.0	7,378.8	7,356.6	7,838.9
EPS (S\$) New	1.68	1.65	1.66	1.74
EPS (S\$) Old	1.68	1.64	1.64	1.74
EPS growth (%)	8.1	(2.0)	0.9	4.8
P/E (X)	8.6	13.0	12.9	12.3
P/B (X)	1.1	1.6	1.5	1.5
Price/PPOP (X)	11.0	11.0	11.0	10.6
Dividend yield (%)	7.0	4.6	4.6	4.1

	9/25	12/25E	3/26E	6/26E
EPS (S\$)	0.44	0.39	0.43	0.43

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

**Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp.
(OCBC.SI)**

Rating since May 2, 2023

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.6	13.0	12.9	12.3
Price/PPOP (X)	11.0	11.0	11.0	10.6
P/B (X)	1.1	1.6	1.5	1.5
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	7.0	4.6	4.6	4.1
Div. payout ratio (%)	60.1	60.1	59.6	50.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	8.9	4.4	4.9	5.3
Total revenue growth	7.2	1.0	1.0	3.8
Op. profit growth	5.4	0.0	(0.0)	4.3
Net inc growth	8.1	(2.2)	0.9	4.8
EPS growth	8.1	(2.0)	0.9	4.8
DPS growth	23.2	(2.0)	0.1	(12.2)

Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0
NPL ratio (%)	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.3	1.3	1.3	1.3
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	45.2	48.8	43.8	39.9
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	144.0	137.1	130.8	125.0

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	17.8	17.6	17.5	17.6

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 25 Feb 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	9,755.0	9,150.0	8,989.2	9,113.7
Net fees	1,970.0	2,411.0	2,660.9	2,918.9
Treasury income	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	2,748.0	3,053.0	3,108.3	3,283.3
Total revenue	14,473.0	14,614.0	14,758.4	15,316.0
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,837.0)	(3,907.0)	—	—
Non-employee costs	(1,905.0)	(1,975.0)	(6,029.1)	(6,209.9)
Pre-provision op. profit	8,731.0	8,732.0	8,729.4	9,106.1
Provision for loans	(561.0)	(610.0)	(701.6)	(781.1)
Total provision expense	(690.0)	(665.0)	(701.6)	(781.1)
Income/(loss) from associates	994.0	1,077.0	1,182.5	1,324.5
Pre-tax profit	8,976.0	9,123.0	9,189.4	9,628.4
Provision for taxes	(1,228.0)	(1,563.0)	(1,562.2)	(1,636.8)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	7,587.0	7,422.0	7,486.9	7,843.7
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	7,587.0	7,422.0	7,486.9	7,843.7
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	1.68	1.65	1.66	1.74
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	1.68	1.65	1.66	1.74
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	4,515.0	4,507.0	4,507.0	4,507.0
Avg. yield on loans (%)	5.1	4.2	3.6	3.3
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.8	4.0	3.3	3.0
Cost of fund (%)	3.0	2.4	1.8	1.6
Net interest margin (%)	2.1	1.8	1.7	1.6

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	68,358.0	72,591.0	76,702.1	81,599.1
Domestic non-mortgages	32,679.0	36,834.0	38,920.0	41,404.9
Domestic commercial lending	196,461.0	206,696.0	218,401.9	232,345.8
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	319,166.0	341,120.0	360,438.7	383,451.1
Total NPLs, gross	2,827.0	3,229.0	3,520.0	3,859.8
Total loan loss reserve	4,070.0	4,428.0	4,603.4	4,826.6
Net customer loans & advances	315,096.0	336,692.0	355,835.4	378,624.6
Other interest earning assets	77,852.0	102,593.0	103,670.8	104,814.6
Interest earning assets	484,270.0	529,489.0	555,482.4	582,697.0
Other non-int. earning assets	140,780.0	146,199.0	152,828.9	159,833.5
Total assets	625,050.0	675,688.0	708,311.3	742,530.5
Risk weighted assets	236,288.0	248,845.0	260,776.8	273,289.8
CASA deposits	190,753.0	217,280.0	242,965.7	267,712.4
Non-CASA deposits	199,934.0	211,006.0	209,446.6	209,683.6
Customer deposits	390,687.0	428,286.0	452,412.3	477,396.0
Other paying liabilities	281.0	197.0	197.0	197.0
Other liabilities	27,652.0	28,474.0	28,474.0	28,474.0
Total liabilities	564,670.0	612,118.0	641,714.3	672,441.4
Total shareholders' equity	60,380.0	63,570.0	66,597.1	70,089.1
Total liabilities & equity	625,050.0	675,688.0	708,311.3	742,530.5
BVPS (\$\$)	12.76	13.33	13.98	14.72
RWA/assets (%)	37.8	36.8	36.8	36.8

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	7.6	6.9	5.7	6.4
Net interest margin (%)	2.1	1.8	1.7	1.6
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	39.3	40.1	40.7	40.4
Tax rate (%)	13.7	17.1	17.0	17.0
CASA ratio (%)	48.8	50.7	53.7	56.1
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	80.7	78.6	78.7	79.3

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.4	2.2	2.1	2.1
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.0	0.9	0.9	0.9
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.3
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.5	1.4	1.3	1.3
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.3	1.1	1.1	1.1
Leverage (X)	10.4	10.6	10.6	10.6
ROE (%)	13.7	12.6	12.2	12.1
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	13.1	12.0	11.5	11.5

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

announced at its FY2024 results by end this year. With management indicating a clearer preference for special dividends, we now anticipate a large part of the remainder of S\$780mn to be returned via special dividend of a similar amount of S\$0.16 as in FY25 in FY26E with the residual amount of S\$60m to still be as buybacks.

Overall, we view the strategic focus on Wealth and ASEAN positively, though we could see a sharper rerating from here on clearer guidance and targets under the new strategy, alongside more tangible execution milestones. Post results, we revise our 2026E-28E net income estimates by +1.8%/+0.1%/+0.5%, to S\$7,487mn/S\$7,844mn/S\$8,285mn as we bake in higher fee growth driven by wealth fees partly offset by lower exit NIM in Dec. Our 12-m 2-stage DDM-based target price is updated to S\$23.5 from S\$23.2 previously.

More details from the briefing key highlights

- **Growth strategy - Sharpening focus on Wealth and growing ASEAN.** OCBC's new growth strategy is centered on wealth-led expansion, with Singapore and Hong Kong positioned as the two key hubs. Wealth management fees remain a core earnings lever, accounting for 60% of total net fee income in FY2025, following a 33% YoY increase to S\$1,234mn. This was underpinned by higher AUM (S\$343bn vs. S\$299bn in Dec-24), a higher proportion of invested AUM (now above 60%), and improving client investment sentiment. Net new AUM inflows reached S\$27bn in FY2025, broad-based across channels. Commitment to the wealth strategy is further reinforced by the establishment of a new Group-level wealth committee, led by senior executives across banking, wealth and insurance, signalling a coordinated, Group-wide focus on its Whole-of-Wealth proposition to provide services to clients across the entire wealth continuum. Through this, management expects cost synergies, although it remains too early to quantify, and continues to guide for double-digit YoY growth in wealth management in FY2026. Hong Kong remains strategically important per management, with the franchise increasingly skewed toward wealth, supported by strong momentum in HK wealth, which grew 60%/70% YoY in FY24/FY25.

Regionally, ASEAN remains the medium-term growth engine, with Malaysia and Indonesia identified as key markets. In Malaysia, OCBC sees opportunities to leverage GEH's sizeable existing customer base, equivalent to around half of Singapore's population to deepen penetration in the affluent customer base. This is complemented by opportunities to capture inbound and cross-border investment flows, including projects such as the MYR15bn development already financed within the Johor-Singapore Special Economic Zone. In Indonesia, the focus remains on growing OCBC Private Bank by tapping into the country's large customer base. To further support ASEAN expansion, selective and strategic M&A remains a viable growth option per OCBC. Overall, management expects stable to improving ROE from the new corporate strategy driven by the focus on higher returning businesses and maintaining cost discipline with CIR at low to mid 40s%.

- **Capital returns - Preference for special dividends over buybacks.** Management was more explicit in signaling a preference for special dividends over share buybacks, as they view it as more accretive to long-term shareholders. Of the remaining ~S\$780mn under the S\$2.5bn capital return programme announced at its

FY2024 results, management reiterated that any unused buyback capacity can be reallocated toward special dividends. Looking ahead, the 50% ordinary dividend payout ratio was reaffirmed as the baseline, with DPS expected to rise from a higher base as management prioritises net income growth. Given the pause in buyback towards the end of last year and on the back of management's preference for special dividends over share buyback we now anticipate a large part of the remainder of capital to be returned via a special dividend of a similar amount of S\$0.16 for FY26E with the residual amount of S\$60m to be in buybacks. This will see dividend yield holding up at 4.6% for 2026E. As for 2027E and 2028E, we remove our previous assumption for the continuation of a 10% special dividend payout given management's stance of using capital for growth. However, there still could be a possibility of more capital returns should OCBC stick to its target of delivering 14% CET1 in the medium term.

- **Asset quality - Remains stable with prudent cost management.** 4Q25 new NPA formation was mainly due to downgrades of 2 corporate RE accounts. Management emphasised that CRE exposures, particularly in Hong Kong is being actively managed and they take comfort in the already conservative NPA coverage of 151% in FY2026 while GP coverage held steady at 0.9%. As such, FY2026 credit cost guidance of 20-25bps range was likely based on a slightly more conservative approach reflecting macro prudence rather than emerging deterioration. Against the backdrop of management's prudent cost discipline, we see credit costs landing toward the lower end of the 20-25bps guidance range.
- **NII - Guidance is set at slight to moderate decline** backed by its house-view that average FY2026 3M SORA would be ~1.4%, retracing from current levels. As a result, management sees upside/downside risk if 3M SORA is below/above 1.4% assumption. Other rates assumptions include ~3.5% for Fed Fund Rate and ~2.8% for 3M HIBOR. Exit NIM in Dec'25 was 1.84%. Alongside this, management guided for mid-single digit loan growth in FY2026 coupled with increasing CASA mix in deposits. Given our forecast of SORA at average 0.94% for 2026E we anticipate NIM to decline by 18bps yoy to 1.73% with a loan growth of 6% and similar deposit growth of 6%, we forecast NII to decline by 2%.

Exhibit 1: OCBC 4Q25 Earnings Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)						Actual vs. Est			
	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	YoY %	QoQ %	4Q25E	(%)
Net Interest Income	2,455	2,345	2,283	2,226	2,296	(6)	3	2,230	3
Fee & Commission	517	546	580	683	602	16	(12)	546	10
Insurance Income	101	306	226	311	226	124	(27)	257	(12)
Other Non-Interest Income	343	458	458	576	492	43	(15)	424	16
Non-Interest Income	961	1,310	1,264	1,570	1,320	37	(16)	1,227	8
Operating Income	3,416	3,655	3,547	3,796	3,616	6	(5)	3,457	5
Operating Expenses	(1,560)	(1,415)	(1,389)	(1,519)	(1,559)	(0)	3	(1,591)	(2)
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	1,856	2,240	2,158	2,277	2,057	11	(10)	1,866	10
Loan Loss Provisions	(208)	(212)	(114)	(139)	(200)	(4)	44	(163)	23
Pre-tax Profit	1,887	2,297	2,301	2,412	2,113	12	(12)	1,952	8
Net Profit	1,687	1,883	1,816	1,978	1,745	3	(12)	1,702	3

Balance sheet (\$\$mn)									
	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25				
Assets	625,050	636,255	644,794	647,812	675,688	8	4	658,335	3
Gross Loans	319,166	322,000	324,606	327,000	341,120	6.9	4.3	330,303	3
Customer Deposits	390,687	402,732	406,943	410,596	428,286	10	4	418,065	2

CAMEL Ratios (%)									
	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25				
Core Tier 1	15.3	15.5	15.3	15.0	15.1			15.4	
NPL Ratio	0.89	0.90	0.92	0.90	0.90			0.92	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	27	26	14	17	24			20	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.15	2.04	1.92	1.84	1.86			1.83	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	45.7	38.7	39.2	40.0	43.1			46.0	
Loan-to-Deposits	81.7	80.0	79.8	79.6	79.6			79.0	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Price Target Risks and Methodology - Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp.

We are Buy rated on OCBC with a 12-month target price of S\$23.5 (based on a two-stage DDM). Key risks include: (-) Sudden or sharper-than-expected Fed cut cycle; (-) Changes in strategy to return capital; and (-) Unexpected dilutive M&A activity.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

I, Melissa Kuang, CFA, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect my personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. I also certify that no part of my compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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Financial Returns and Multiple use the Goldman Sachs analyst forecasts at the fiscal year-end at least three quarters in the future. Growth uses inputs for the fiscal year at least seven quarters in the future compared with the year at least three quarters in the future (on a per-share basis for all metrics).

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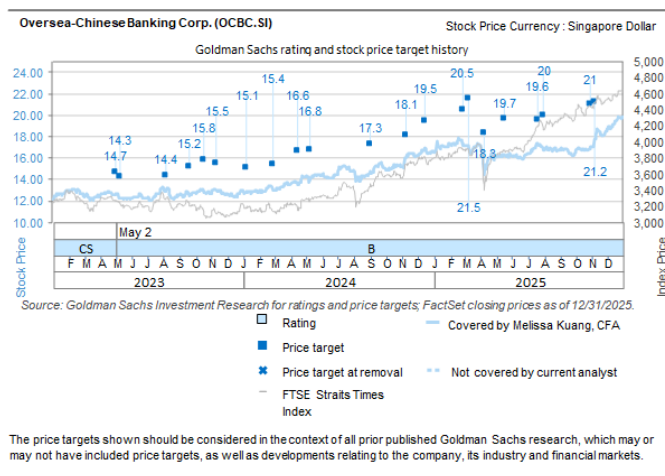
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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